

Connecticut State Department of Education

DISTRICT PROFILE AND PERFORMANCE REPORT FOR SCHOOL YEAR 2023–24



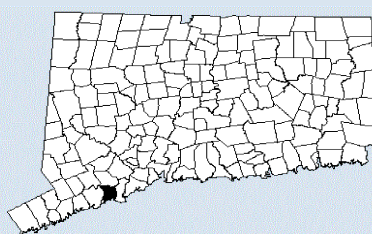
The Bridge Academy District

Tyrone Elliott, Superintendent • 203-336-9999 • <http://www.bridgeacademy.org>

District Information

Grade Range	7-12
Number of Schools/Programs	1
Enrollment	281
Per Pupil Expenditures ¹	\$16,552
Total Expenditures ¹	\$4,634,617

¹ Expenditure data reflect the 2022-23 school year.



Community Information

AdvanceCT Town Profiles provide summary demographic and economic information for Connecticut's municipalities at <https://www.advancect.org/site-selection/town-profiles>

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Notes

Unless otherwise noted, all data are for 2023-24 and include all grades offered by the district.

In most tables, data are displayed only for the three major race/ethnicity categories. For additional race/ethnicity categories, please visit <https://edsight.ct.gov>

State totals are not displayed as they are not comparable to district totals.

Special Education tables reflect only students for whom the district is fiscally responsible.

* When an asterisk is displayed, data have been suppressed to safeguard student confidentiality. Complete data suppression guidelines are available at <https://tinyurl.com/SuppressionPolicy>

N/A is displayed when a category is not applicable for a district or school.

Students

October 1, 2023 Enrollment²

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
Female	131	46.6	48.3
Male	150	53.4	51.5
Non-Binary	0	0.0	0.1
American Indian or Alaska Native	0	0.0	0.2
Asian	*	*	5.2
Black or African American	139	49.5	12.5
Hispanic or Latino of any race	129	45.9	31.1
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	*	*	0.1
Two or More Races	6	2.1	4.7
White	*	*	46.2
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	11	3.9	10.5
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	242	86.1	44.0
Students with Disabilities ³	51	18.1	17.9

² This table represents students in grades PK-12 reported by the district in the Public School Information System (i.e., PSIS Reporting District).

³ Students in this category are students with an individualized education program (IEP) only. This category does not include students with Section 504 plans or services plans.

Chronic Absenteeism and Suspension/Expulsion

	Chronic Absenteeism ⁴		Suspension/Expulsion ⁵	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	27	21.6	10	7.5
Male	23	16.1	10	6.5
Non-Binary	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A
Black or African American	18	13.4	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	30	24.6	10	7.7
White	*	*	0	*
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	*	*	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	49	20.9	18	7.1
Students with Disabilities	11	23.9	7	13.2
District	50	18.7	20	7.0
State		17.7		7.0

Number of students qualified as truant under state statute: Fewer than 6

Number of school-based arrests: 0

⁴ A student is chronically absent if they miss ten percent or greater of the total number of days enrolled in the school year for any reason. Pre-Kindergarten students are excluded from this calculation.

⁵ This column displays the count and percentage of students who receive at least one in-school suspension, out-of-school suspension or expulsion.

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Educators

Full-Time Equivalent (FTE)¹ Staff

	FTE
General Education	
Teachers and Instructors	13.6
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	12.0
Special Education	
Teachers and Instructors	3.0
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	1.0
Administrators, Coordinators and Department Chairs	
District Central Office	2.2
School Level	0.0
Library/Media	
Specialists (Certified)	0.0
Support Staff	0.0
Instructional Specialists Who Support Teachers	1.0
Counselors, Social Workers and School Psychologists	4.8
School Nurses	1.0
Other Staff Providing Non-Instructional Services/Support	8.5

¹ In the full-time equivalent count, staff members working part-time in the school are counted as a fraction of full-time. For example, a teacher who works half-time in a school contributes 0.50 to the school's staff count.

Educators by Race/Ethnicity

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
American Indian or Alaska Native	0	0.0	0.1
Asian	0	0.0	1.4
Black or African American	4	16.0	4.8
Hispanic or Latino of any race	3	12.0	5.1
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	0.0	0.1
Two or More Races	0	0.0	0.3
White	18	72.0	88.3

Classroom Teacher Attendance: 2022-23

	District	State
Average Number of FTE Days Absent Due to Illness or Personal Time	12.1	13.3

Instruction and Resources

11th and 12th Graders Enrolled in College-and-Career-Readiness Courses during High School²

	11th		12th	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Black or African American	*	*	22	100.0
Hispanic or Latino of any race	20	80.0	13	*
White	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	*	*	0	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	34	82.9	*	*
Students with Disabilities	6	*	7	*
District	34	82.9	35	97.2
State		88.4		94.6

² College-and-Career-Readiness Courses include Advanced Placement®(AP), International Baccalaureate®(IB), Career and Technical Education(CTE), workplace experience and dual credit courses.

Students Who Spend 80% or Greater Time with Nondisabled Peers³

	Count	Rate (%)
Autism	N/A	N/A
Emotional Disability	N/A	N/A
Intellectual Disability	N/A	N/A
Learning Disability	N/A	N/A
Other Health Impairment	N/A	N/A
Other Disabilities	N/A	N/A
Speech/Language Impairment	N/A	N/A
District	N/A	N/A
State		66.8

³ This table represents students ages 6-21 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

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Students with Disabilities by Primary Disability¹

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Autism	N/A	N/A	2.6
Emotional Disability	N/A	N/A	1.1
Intellectual Disability	N/A	N/A	0.6
Learning Disability	N/A	N/A	6.4
Other Health Impairment	N/A	N/A	3.5
Other Disabilities	N/A	N/A	1.2
Speech/Language Impairment	N/A	N/A	2.0
All Disabilities	N/A	N/A	17.3

¹ This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Students with Disabilities Placed Outside of the District²

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Public Schools in Other Districts	N/A	N/A	8.0
Private Schools or Other Settings	N/A	N/A	4.6

² This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Overall Expenditures³: 2022-23

	Total (\$)	Per Pupil	
		District (\$)	State (\$)
Instruction	\$2,277,828	\$8,135	\$12,942
Support services - students	\$1,105,528	\$3,948	\$1,724
Support services - instruction	\$116,081	\$415	\$905
Support services - general administration	\$72,668	\$260	\$520
Support services - school based administration	\$802,000	\$2,864	\$1,207
Central and other support services	.	.	\$771
Operation and maintenance of plant	\$240,318	\$858	\$2,101
Student transportation services	\$20,194	\$72	\$1,582
Food services	.	.	\$8
Enterprise operations	.	.	\$213
Total	\$4,634,617	\$16,552	\$21,143

³ Expenditures may be supported by local tax revenues, state grants, federal grants, municipal in-kind services, tuition and other sources.

Special Education Expenditures: 2022-23

	District		State
	Total (\$)	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Teacher Salaries	\$324,487	87.9	27.6
Instructional Aide Salaries	.	.	10.2
Other Salaries	.	.	10.5
Employee Benefits	\$44,570	12.1	13.2
Purchased Services Other Than Transportation	.	.	6.4
Special Education Tuition	.	.	22.2
Supplies	.	.	0.7
Property Services	.	.	0.4
Purchased Services For Transportation	.	.	8.4
Equipment	.	.	0.3
All Other Expenditures	.	.	0.1
Total	\$369,058	100.0	100.0
Percent of Total Expenditures Used for Special Education		8.0	25.0

Expenditures by Revenue Source⁴: 2022-23

	Percent of Total (%) Excluding School Construction
Local	8.0
State	71.6
Federal	18.1
Tuition & Other	2.3

⁴ Revenue sources do not include state-funded Teachers' Retirement Board contributions, Connecticut Technical Education and Career System (CTECS) operations, CSDE-budgeted costs for salaries and leadership activities and other state-funded school districts (e.g., Dept. of Children and Families and Dept. of Correction).

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Performance and Accountability

District Performance Index (DPI)

A District Performance Index (DPI) is the average performance of students in a subject area (i.e., ELA, Mathematics or Science) on the state summative assessments. The DPI ranges from 0-100. A DPI is reported for all students tested in a district and for students in each individual student group. Connecticut's ultimate target for a DPI is 75.

	English Language Arts (ELA)		Math		Science	
	Count	DPI	Count	DPI	Count	DPI
American Indian or Alaska Native	0	N/A	0	N/A	0	N/A
Asian	*	*	*	*	*	*
Black or African American	55	54.4	55	55.4	37	46.3
Hispanic or Latino of any race	71	50.5	71	49.7	46	46.1
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	N/A	0	N/A	0	N/A
Two or More Races	*	*	*	*	*	*
White	*	*	*	*	0	N/A
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	*	*	*	*	*	*
Non-English Learners/Non-Multilingual Learners	*	*	*	*	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	117	49.8	117	49.1	75	45.0
Not Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	18	*	18	*	11	*
Students with Disabilities	19	*	19	*	13	*
Students without Disabilities	116	54.7	116	54.2	73	48.9
High Needs	117	49.8	117	49.1	75	45.0
Non-High Needs	18	*	18	*	11	*
District	135	52.0	135	51.7	86	46.2

National Assessment of Educational Progress (NAEP): Percent At or Above Proficient¹

	NAEP 2022		NAEP 2013
	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
READING			
Connecticut	35	35	50
National Public	32	29	36
MATH			
Connecticut	37	30	32
National Public	35	26	25

¹ NAEP is often called the "Nation's Report Card." It is sponsored by the U.S. Department of Education. This table compares Connecticut's performance to that of national public school students. Performance standards for state assessments and NAEP are set independently. Therefore, one should not expect performance results to be the same across Smarter Balanced and NAEP. Instead, NAEP results are meant to complement other state assessment data. To view performance on NAEP by student group, at

https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Student-Assessment/NAEP/report-card_NAEP-2022.pdf

Physical Fitness Tests: Students Reaching Health Standard²

	Percent of Students by Grade ³ (%)				All Tested Grades	
	4	6	8	HS	Count	Rate (%)
Sit & Reach	N/A	N/A	68.9	87.0	91	78.0
Curl Up	N/A	N/A	84.4	89.1	91	86.8
Push Up	N/A	N/A	75.6	67.4	91	71.4
Mile Run/PACER	N/A	N/A	62.2	89.1	91	75.8
All Tests - District	N/A	N/A	46.7	60.9	91	53.8
All Tests - State	53.6	48.4	44.6	42.3		47.2

²The Connecticut Physical Fitness Assessment (CPFA) is administered to students in Grades 4, 6, 8 and High School (HS). The health-related fitness scores gathered through the CPFA should be used to educate and motivate children and their families to increase physical activity and develop lifetime fitness habits.

³Only students assessed in all four areas are included in this calculation.

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Cohort Graduation: Four-Year¹

	2022-23	
	Cohort Count ²	Rate (%)
Black or African American	21	95.2
Hispanic or Latino of any race	15	*
White	N/A	N/A
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	28	96.4
Students with Disabilities	6	*
District	36	97.2
State		88.4

¹ The four-year cohort graduation rate represents the percentage of first-time 9th graders who earn a standard high school diploma within four years.

² Cohort count includes all students in the cohort as of the end of the 2022-23 school year.

11th and 12th Graders Demonstrating Postsecondary Readiness³

	Count	Rate (%)
Female	14	46.7
Male	27	57.4
Non-Binary	N/A	N/A
Black or African American	24	64.9
Hispanic or Latino	17	43.6
White	N/A	N/A
English Learners/ Multilingual Learners	0	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	*	*
Students with Disabilities	7	*
District	41	53.2
State		44.3

³Students demonstrate postsecondary readiness through at least one of the following:

- SAT® - meets benchmark score on SAT, Revised SAT or Connecticut School Day SAT
- ACT® - meets benchmark score on 3 of 4 exams (benchmark score varies by subject)
- AP® - 3 or higher on any one AP® exam
- IB® - 4 or higher on any one IB® exam
- Earning three or more non-remedial college credits cumulatively during high school.

Sources:

SAT® and AP® statistics derived from data provided by the College Board.

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ACT® statistics derived from data provided by ACT, Inc.

Copyright © 2024 ACT, Inc. www.act.org

IB® statistics derived from data provided by the International Baccalaureate Organization.

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College Entrance and Persistence

	Class of 2023	Class of 2022
	Entrance ⁵ Rate (%)	Persistence ⁶ Rate (%)
Female	81.0	*
Male	*	*
Non-Binary	N/A	N/A
Black or African American	81.0	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	*	*
White	N/A	*
English Learners/ Multilingual Learners	*	N/A
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	71.4	*
Students with Disabilities	*	*
District	73.0	58.6
State	68.4	87.2

⁵ College entrance refers to the percent of high school graduates from the year who enrolled in college any time during the first year after high school.

⁶ College persistence refers to the percent of students who enrolled in college the first year after high school and returned for a second year (Freshman to Sophomore persistence).

Source: National Student Clearinghouse

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Next Generation Accountability Results

Connecticut's Next Generation Accountability System is a broad set of 12 indicators that help tell the story of how well a district/school is preparing its students for success in college, careers, and life. It moves beyond test scores and graduation rates to provide a more holistic, multifactor perspective of district and school performance.

Indicator		Index/Rate	Target	Points Earned	Max Points	% Points Earned	State Average Index/Rate
ELA Performance Index	All Students	52.0	75	34.7	50	69.3	63.9
	High Needs Students	49.8	75	33.2	50	66.4	54.1
Math Performance Index	All Students	51.7	75	34.5	50	69.0	60.2
	High Needs Students	49.1	75	32.7	50	65.4	49.5
Science Performance Index	All Students	46.2	75	30.8	50	61.7	61.8
	High Needs Students	45.0	75	30.0	50	60.0	51.4
ELA Academic Growth	All Students	54.7%	100%	54.7	100	54.7	58.7%
	High Needs Students	53.7%	100%	53.7	100	53.7	54.2%
Math Academic Growth	All Students	78.8%	100%	78.8	100	78.8	61.4%
	High Needs Students	73.9%	100%	73.9	100	73.9	55.1%
Progress Toward English Proficiency	Literacy	.	100%	.	.	.	58.9%
	Oral	.	100%	.	.	.	55.2%
Chronic Absenteeism	All Students	18.7%	<=5%	22.7	50	45.4	17.7%
	High Needs Students	20.7%	<=5%	18.6	50	37.3	25.5%
Preparation for CCR	% Taking Courses	89.6%	75%	50.0	50	100.0	91.5%
	% Meeting Benchmark	53.2%	75%	35.5	50	71.0	44.3%
On-track to High School Graduation		94.9%	94%	50.0	50	100.0	84.5%
4-year Graduation All Students (2023 Cohort)		97.2%	94%	100.0	100	100.0	88.4%
6-year Graduation - High Needs Students (2021 Cohort)		87.9%	94%	93.5	100	93.5	86.6%
Postsecondary Entrance (Class of 2023)		73.0%	75%	97.3	100	97.3	68.4%
Physical Fitness (estimated part rate) and (fitness rate)		98.9% 53.8%	75%	35.9	50	71.8	93.6% 47.2%
Arts Access		21.3%	60%	17.7	50	35.4	55.0%
Accountability Index				978.3	1350	72.5	

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in the student group or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Gap Indicators	Non-High Needs Rate ¹	High Needs Rate	Size of Gap	State Gap Mean +1 Stdev ²	Is Gap an Outlier? ²
Achievement Gap Size Outlier?					N
ELA Performance Index Gap	.	49.8	.	16.9	
Math Performance Index Gap	.	49.1	.	18.2	
Science Performance Index Gap	.	45.0	.	17.9	
Graduation Rate Gap	.	87.9%	.	9.9%	N

¹If the Non-High Needs Rate exceeds the ultimate target (75 for Performance Index and 94% for graduation rate), the ultimate target is used for gap calculations.

²If the size of the gap exceeds the state mean gap plus one standard deviation, the gap is an outlier.

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in at least one of the student groups used to calculate the gap measure or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served. Gap calculations are based on unrounded rates.

Subject/Student Group		Participation Rate (%) ³
ELA	All Students	100.0
	High Needs Students	100.0
Math	All Students	100.0
	High Needs Students	100.0
Science	All Students	100.0
	High Needs Students	100.0

³Minimum participation standard is 95%.

Connecticut's State Identified Measurable Result (SIMR) for Children with Disabilities

Increase the reading performance of all 3rd grade students with disabilities statewide, as measured by Connecticut's English Language Arts (ELA) Performance Index.

Grade 3 ELA Performance Index for Students with Disabilities:

District: N/A State: 49.7

Supporting Resources: <https://public-edsight.ct.gov/Overview/Next-Generation-Accountability-Dashboard#related-links>

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Narratives

School District Improvement Plans and Parental Outreach Activities

At Bridge Academy we are committed to offering students with IEP's an inclusion model with high expectations for academic and social/emotional growth and the support students need to succeed in class, on important assessments and in life. Toward this end, we review and revise all IEP goals annually to ensure that they meet each student's individual and academic needs. All general education teachers meet with special education teachers bi-weekly to review progress toward goals and determine next steps. All students receive one small group class period a day each of leveled literacy and numeracy instruction and receive one class period a day of intervention support. Special education teachers meet regularly with a special education consultant to ensure that they are constantly improving their practice and their support of both students and families.

In order to reduce chronic absenteeism and raise attendance rates, we follow our Tiered Attendance Plan to first work to create a positive culture and climate. We do this in part by planning multiple opportunities for school connection throughout the year, including morning advisories, student-led whole school assemblies, activity days, field trips and a robust after school program. We carefully monitor the academic and social/emotional needs of every student and respond accordingly with everything from creating tutoring programs to meetings with our social workers to enabling families to get the outside help they need. Our Attendance Committee consists of social workers, administrators, teachers, paraprofessionals, our Social Emotional Learning Coordinator, school counselor, secretaries and nurse. This team meets bi-weekly to identify barriers to attendance and create individual plans for struggling students to ensure they come to school every day. In addition, we have created a school Uber account to transport students who have no other way of getting to school. Lastly, we also purchase monthly bus passes for students for whom the walk to school is a barrier to attendance.

In order to create the best possible partnership with families, conduct Parent Teacher Home Visits for all 7th graders. We will continue to host regular meetings around themes of interest to our community including how to support reading and math growth at home and how to support student social/emotional well-being, physical health and nutrition. We have parent representation on our Governing Council and hold one or two Climate Committee Meetings virtually in the evenings to allow for greater parent participation. We regularly survey our students and families to learn their opinions on a range of topics in order to better meet their needs. We have two Family Engagement coordinators who are responsible for ensuring that our families feel supported and heard throughout the year. We also conduct student and parent focus groups and surveys to ensure that all community voices are heard.

In the 2021-2022 school year we received a grant to partner with SchoolWorks, a school improvement organization, as part of our work to move from good to great. This partnership has led to demonstrable improvements in professional development implementation and instruction.

Efforts to Reduce Racial, Ethnic and Economic Isolation

Our enrollment application is simple and asks only for a student's demographic information. It can be found on our website in both English and Spanish. We also advertise on local Spanish radio stations. Applicants are admitted through a lottery.

We work to reduce racial and economic isolation by allowing any interested student to apply and attend regardless of residency. This allows us to enroll students from a range of cultural and socio-economic backgrounds.

We are committed to recruiting and hiring a diverse group of teachers and staff; our staff currently consists of more than 50% people of color. We also have six staff members who were former students.

Our curriculum is designed to increase awareness of various cultures and points of view. Teachers also regularly share the accomplishments of underrepresented groups such as people of color and women in fields such as science, mathematics and history. Our English curriculum focuses on literature that acts as "windows and mirrors" for our students.

We partner with a number of community and state-wide organizations in order to expose our students to a range of activities and opportunities. For example, we have a group of students that goes to Beardsley Zoo once a month to learn about ecosystems, animal habitats and more through our Trout in the Classroom program. All of our high school students take Housatonic Community College and Post University classes for free through our partnership with these schools. We also work with several mental health organizations to ensure our students and staff get the support they need.

Many of the clubs offered through our after school program introduce students to activities they may not otherwise be exposed to such as Outdoors Club, Spoken Word Poetry Club, Rock Climbing, learning to be a docent at the African American Museum in Stratford, Lifeguard Training, learning to be a tour guide at the zoo, Media Club and Anime Club.

We also encourage field trips that will expand our students' horizons and support their learning. Trips to concerts, museums, aquariums, nature parks, skiing, and the state legislature, give students exposure to art, culture and nature that they may not otherwise have an opportunity to experience.

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Equitable Allocation of Resources among District Schools

Since our "district" is made up of only one school this question is not applicable.